

REPORT WRITING - Guidelines

A report is a factual, non-fictional account of an event, issue or topic. It presents information in a clear, concise and organised manner so that readers who are unfamiliar with the subject can understand it easily.

Types of Reports

Magazine Report	Newspaper Report
Descriptive and engaging	Factual and objective
Focuses on the event's atmosphere and significance	Focuses on reporting facts
May use more expressive language / formal	Uses concise and formal language
Written for a specific magazine audience	Written for the general public

Features of a Good Report

A well-written report should demonstrate:

- Adherence to the given specifications
- Collection and analysis of relevant information
- Logical and coherent organisation of ideas
- Consistent presentation
- Appropriate conclusions supported by facts and evidence
- Clear, concise and objective language

Format of a Magazine Report

Component	Details
Heading	Title of the report
Byline	Name of the writer

Opening Paragraph	Introduction to the event
Account of the Event	Description of the event in chronological order
Conclusion	How the event concluded and its significance

Structure of a Magazine Report

1. Heading

- Should be brief, catchy and informative

2. Byline

- Name of the writer

3. Opening Paragraph (Introduction)

Include the **5 Ws**:

- **What** happened?
- **Why** was the event organised?
- **When** did it take place?
- **Where** was it held?
- **Who** was the chief guest?

4. Account of the Event

- Describe the sequence of events
- Include important highlights
- Mention performances, speeches, competitions or other activities
- Maintain chronological order

5. Conclusion

- Explain how the event concluded
- Include the chief guest's remarks, awards, vote of thanks or the overall impact of the event

Format of a Newspaper Report

Component	Details
Headline	Title of the report
Byline	Name and designation of the reporter
Place and Date	Place and Dateline
Opening Paragraph	Summary of the event
Account of the Event	Detailed description
Witness Remarks	Comments from participants or eyewitnesses
Conclusion	Final outcome or significance

Structure of a Newspaper Report

HEADLINE

By _____

Place, Date

Opening Paragraph: Answer the 5 Ws (What, Why, When, Where, Who).

Body: Describe the event in detail; Present facts in chronological order; Include statements from participants, organisers or witnesses.

Conclusion: Explain how the event ended and Mention its significance or future implications.

Important Tips

- Use the **past tense**
 - Use **third-person narration**
 - Be **objective and factual**
 - Follow a **chronological sequence**
 - Avoid personal opinions
 - Keep the language **formal and concise**
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Useful Expressions

Introducing the Event

- The school organised...
- An inter-school competition was held...
- The programme commenced with...
- The event aimed to...

Describing the Event

- The chief guest inaugurated the event...
- Students enthusiastically participated in...
- The audience appreciated...
- The programme featured...

Concluding the Report

- The event concluded with...
- The programme ended on a positive note...
- The vote of thanks was delivered by...
- The event left a lasting impression on everyone present...

SAMPLE REPORTS

Report for a Magazine

MMD School, Nasik, recently organised a science symposium on the topic: 'Effect of pollution on quality of life'. You are Amrit/Amrita Raazdan, editor of the school magazine. Write a report on the event for your school magazine. (120 – 150 words)

Science Symposium (Heading)

- By Amrit Raazdan
(Byline)

MMD School, Nasik, organised a science symposium on 1 March 2022 on the topic, 'Effect of Pollution on Quality of Life'. The programme was attended by science students and aimed to create awareness about the growing environmental crisis and its impact on human life.

(5 Ws identified:

- What? A science symposium on 'Effect of Pollution on Quality of Life'
- Why? To create awareness about the growing environmental crisis and its impact on human life
- When? 1 March 2022
- Where? MMD School, Nasik
- Who? Science students attended the programme)

The event began with the felicitation of the guest speakers, followed by an address by Mr Suraj Prakash, who explained the objectives of the symposium. Dr Hari Om Gupta, the resource person, spoke about the harmful effects of pollution and emphasised the urgent need to adopt sustainable practices. The post-lunch session, conducted by Dr K.K. Arora, focused on practical measures that individuals can take to reduce pollution. Interactive discussions and demonstrations encouraged students to think of innovative solutions to environmental problems. (Account of the Event)

(Highlights included:

- Felicitation of the guest speakers
- Address by Mr Suraj Prakash
- Session by Dr Hari Om Gupta
- Post-lunch session by Dr K.K. Arora

- Interactive discussions and demonstrations)

The informative and thought-provoking symposium concluded with a vote of thanks delivered by the Head of the Science Department. (Conclusion)

Report for a Newspaper

A devastating cyclone recently struck Odisha, causing widespread destruction and displacing thousands. Relief and rescue operations have been launched in the affected areas. As Rhea, a staff reporter for The Times of India, write a newspaper report on the disaster and the relief measures undertaken in 120–150 words.

Relief Efforts Intensify in Cyclone-Hit Odisha (Headline)

- By Rhea, Staff Reporter (Byline)

Bhubaneswar, 3 November 2025 (Dateline)

A devastating cyclone that recently struck Odisha caused widespread destruction, claiming thousands of lives and leaving millions homeless. The worst-affected regions included Jagatsinghpur, Kendrapara and Paradip, where strong winds, heavy rainfall and severe flooding damaged houses, roads, communication networks and public infrastructure. Opening Paragraph (What, Where, When, and Impact)

The state and central governments immediately launched extensive relief and rescue operations. Food packets, drinking water, medicines and other essential supplies were air-dropped into inaccessible areas. Relief camps were established to provide temporary shelter to displaced families, while medical teams were deployed to prevent the outbreak of waterborne diseases. (Account of the Event (Details of the Incident and Relief Measures))
“We have lost our homes and belongings, but the relief teams have given us hope. We are grateful for the food, water and medical assistance,” said a resident of Kendrapara. (Witness Remarks)

Despite these efforts, nearly 1.5 crore people continued to face shortages of food, electricity and potable water. Reports of looting and the disruption of transport and communication further complicated rescue operations. The Bhubaneswar airport remained non-operational because of severe damage to its facilities. (Further Account) Although relief measures are progressing, experts believe that large-scale rehabilitation and sustained government support will be essential to restore normalcy in the affected areas. (Conclusion)

PRACTICE QUESTIONS - Reports for a Magazine

1. Your school recently organized a three-day literary festival that included panel discussions, poetry recitations, creative writing workshops and interactions with renowned authors. As Ananya Mehta, Editor of the school magazine, write a report on the event in 120–150 words.
2. The Science Club of your school organized an exhibition titled "Beyond the Stars" to promote interest in astronomy and space exploration. Scientists from ISRO interacted with students and demonstrated various space technologies. As Aryan Sharma, Editor of the school magazine, write a report in 120–150 words.
3. Your school recently hosted an inter-school Model United Nations (MUN) Conference that brought together students from different schools to debate global issues such as climate change, cybersecurity and international conflicts. As Meera Nair, Editor of the school magazine, write a report on the event in 120–150 words.
4. A week-long cultural programme titled "Roots and Rhythms" was organized to revive traditional Indian art forms through exhibitions, workshops and performances by local artists. As Karan Malhotra, Editor of the school magazine, write a report in 120–150 words.
5. Your school launched a year-long environmental campaign that included waste segregation, rainwater harvesting, tree plantation and a plastic-free campus drive. As Sanya Kapoor, Editor of the school magazine, write a report on the initiative in 120–150 words.
6. A two-day workshop on Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning was organized for senior secondary students. Experts from the technology industry

conducted interactive sessions and hands-on activities. As Pranav Gupta, Editor of the school magazine, write a report in 120–150 words.

7. Students of your school participated in a heritage walk followed by an exhibition showcasing the history and architecture of your city. The event aimed to promote awareness of local history and cultural preservation. As Ishita Sen, Editor of the school magazine, write a report in 120–150 words.
8. Your school observed Mental Health Awareness Week through expert talks, theatre performances, mindfulness sessions and student-led discussions. The programme emphasized emotional well-being and stress management among adolescents. As Dev Khanna, Editor of the school magazine, write a report in 120–150 words.
9. The Commerce and Economics Departments organized an Entrepreneurship Fair where students presented innovative business ideas and sustainable start-up models. Industry experts evaluated the projects and interacted with participants. As Aditi Rao, Editor of the school magazine, write a report in 120–150 words.
10. Your school organized an International Food and Literature Festival to explore the relationship between cuisine and literary traditions across different cultures. The programme included food exhibitions, dramatic performances and book discussions. As Nikhil Verma, Editor of the school magazine, write a report in 120–150 words.

PRACTICE QUESTIONS - Reports for a Newspaper

1. A flash flood in Uttarakhand severely damaged a 300-year-old temple and several nearby villages. Relief and restoration work has already begun. As Rhea/Roy, a staff reporter for 'The Times of India', write a newspaper report in 120–150 words on the disaster and the measures taken by the authorities.
2. The Ministry of Education has introduced AI-enabled smart classrooms in government schools across the country. As Manav /Maanvi, a reporter for The 'Times of India', write a newspaper report in 120–150 words highlighting the objectives, implementation and expected impact of the initiative.

3. A forest fire in a national park destroyed large areas of vegetation and threatened several endangered species. Rescue teams and environmental agencies launched emergency operations. As Raja/Raani, write a report for 'The Times of India' in 120–150 words.
4. India's latest space mission successfully deployed a research satellite designed to study climate patterns. Scientists and students across the country celebrated the achievement. As Taran / Trisha, write a newspaper report for 'The Times of India' in 120–150 words.
5. A major cyberattack affected banking services, traffic systems and government portals in a metropolitan city. Authorities have initiated investigations and strengthened security measures. As Ashish / Ashika, write a newspaper report in 120–150 words.
6. Hundreds of students and volunteers participated in a six-month campaign to restore a polluted urban lake. The project resulted in a significant improvement in water quality. As Rajath / Rithika, write a report for The Times of India in 120–150 words.
7. A week-long literary festival featuring renowned authors, translators and historians concluded recently in Jaipur. Thousands of readers attended the event. As Ram/Ramya, write a newspaper report in 120–150 words.
8. An unprecedented heat wave led several states to suspend classes temporarily. Health officials issued advisories, and emergency measures were implemented to protect students. As Nithin/ Nithya, write a report for 'The Times of India' in 120–150 words.
9. Archaeologists recently discovered an ancient settlement believed to be more than 2,000 years old. The discovery has generated considerable interest among historians. As Rohan/ Rohini, write a newspaper report in 120–150 words.
10. The collapse of a major bridge disrupted transportation and affected thousands of commuters. Rescue teams, engineers and government agencies responded immediately. As Aaron / Anvitha, write a newspaper report for 'The Times of India' in 120–150 words.

